NCCA ENTERTAINMENT

TV ONE PITCH PACKET

THE ALIBI

She covered up a murder to save her marriage. The marriage was the crime.

Format	TV One Original Movie
Genre	Domestic Suspense Thriller
Setting	Atlanta, Georgia (single city, incentive-eligible)
Written by	Kelly R. Tenney
Submitted by	NCCA Entertainment
Contact	contact@nccaentertainment.com
Status	Complete draft, polished and ready for buyer read

The One Liner

A judge nominee wakes up next to a murdered woman in her own bed with no memory of the night before and destroys the evidence to protect her career and her marriage, never realizing the husband she's protecting is the one who framed her.

Buyer Logline

On the night Eleanor Hayes is honored as Georgia's next Court of Appeals judge, she wakes up beside a murdered woman in her own bed with no memory of how she got there. To save her career, her marriage, and her freedom, she cleans the scene and builds a lie strong enough to survive a homicide investigation. But the husband she's protecting isn't the victim of this story. He's the reason it happened.

Why TV One

THE ALIBI is built for exactly the promise TV One makes its audience: a Black woman at the center of a suspense story the whole family can watch and talk about the next morning. The thriller mechanics (the fabricated footage, the locked-room chain, the emergency courtroom trap) never outrun the human story underneath them, a marriage built on a lie, a sister who won't let her grief be filed away, a wife who has to out-lawyer the man who taught her how. Every act break raises a stake the audience already understands in their gut: reputation, family, trust, survival. It's an accessible event movie with a legible emotional problem at its center, exactly the lane TV One owns.

Synopsis

ELEANOR HAYES, 44, is the woman everyone in Atlanta's Black legal establishment is toasting tonight, hours from a Georgia Court of Appeals nomination. She wakes up the next morning next to a dead woman in her own bed, her husband JORDAN gone, and no memory of the night before.

Certain that a Black woman found alone with a body never gets the benefit of the doubt, Eleanor makes a choice that will cost her everything: she cleans the scene, hides the body, and builds an alibi, pulling in her best friend and crisis-PR fixer JASMINE to help her survive the next seventy-two hours. But the dead woman has a sister. DESTINY CARTER won't let her sister's disappearance become a footnote, and DETECTIVE NIA OKAFOR is quietly, patiently building a real case, one doorbell camera and one late night at a time.

As the walls close in, Eleanor discovers a second phone, a hidden mistress, and a financial trail that leads straight back to her own husband's company. The bedroom door was chained from the inside the morning she woke up. The footage that puts her behind the wheel of the getaway car was never actually recorded. And the man she's been protecting has been managing her panic from a burner phone the entire time.

When Eleanor is arrested on her own front porch, she finally starts to remember the night she was drugged, and who really carried a body to that bed. What follows is a legal ambush only a woman who spent twenty years cross-examining witnesses could build: an emergency courtroom hearing where Eleanor forces her husband into the one room he can't charm his way out of and reads the truth into the record herself.

Cast Suggestions

TV One casts for faces the audience already trusts, recognizable without requiring a feature-film budget. This wishlist is sized to that reality: reach names to anchor the poster, working TV-movie talent to fill it out. Eight principal roles total, no oversized ensemble.

Character	Role	Suggested Talent
Eleanor Hayes, 44	Lead — Atlanta attorney, Court of Appeals nominee, unravels while protecting the husband framing her	Sanaa Lathan, Nicole Ari Parker, KJ Smith
Jordan Hayes, 46	Lead — Eleanor's husband, developer with a hidden double life and a corruption scheme to protect	Morris Chestnut, Hosea Chanchez, McKinley Freeman
Jasmine, 40s	Supporting — Eleanor's best friend and crisis-PR fixer, builds the cover story and later breaks it	Erica Tazel, Nadine Ellis, Tami Roman
Destiny Carter, 29	Supporting — Mika's sister, an ER nurse who won't let the case close	Demetria McKinney, Denise Boutte
Det. Nia Okafor, 38	Supporting — the one detective who actually looks twice	Angela Robinson, Toni Trucks
Alice Hayes, 70s	Featured — Eleanor's mother, a pastor's widow	Vanessa Bell Calloway, Lynn Whitfield
Marcus Kane, 50s	Featured — city councilman, Jordan's co-conspirator	Dorian Missick, Hill Harper

Comparable Titles

Title	Where	Shared DNA
Under the Influence	TV One Original Movie	Marriage as the site of danger; a partner who isn't who he says he is
First Comes Love, Then Comes Murder	TV One Original Movie	Domestic thriller engine, accessible mystery, Black audience POV
Fatal Affair	Feature thriller	Black female lead carrying a tightening, personal thriller
How to Get Away with Murder	ABC series	A brilliant legal mind forced to out-lawyer the people closest to her
Presumed Innocent	Premium limited series	Tonal north star for the evidentiary/courtroom tension, told at TV One's accessible scale

Production Notes

Built to be shot the way TV One actually shoots.

- Single city: Atlanta, Georgia, a state with strong production incentives and TV One's own home turf.
- Roughly 90% interiors. One standing set carries most of the picture (the Hayes residence: bedroom, kitchen, garage, home office), supplemented by a police precinct, a courthouse/examination room, a law office, a salon, and a hospital break room.
- Eight principal speaking roles (5 leads, 3 supporting), plus a small bench of day players. No oversized ensemble to cast or schedule around.
- No stunts, no chases, no practical or CG effects beyond a laptop-screen insert for the fabricated-footage reveal, cheap and entirely achievable in post.
- Two contained crowd moments (the opening gala, the closing arrest/press scrum), both scalable to a modest extras budget.
- Reads as a standard 15-18 day shoot at TV One's typical original-movie budget and schedule.

Trailer Moments / Key Art

Six beats that cut a trailer on their own:

- The cold open: Eleanor wakes up next to a body in her own bed.
- The chain still latched from the inside. Nobody could have gotten out.
- A name on a burner phone: Simone.
- The gate footage that puts her behind the wheel, twenty minutes after the gala ends.
- The examination room: “I'm reading into the record a forensic analysis...”
- Eleanor Hayes, nominee to the Georgia Court of Appeals, cuffed on her own front porch.

Key art direction: Eleanor and Jordan in silhouette, back to back, a cracked wedding photo or a courtroom gavel bridging the space between them. Tagline: “She covered up a murder to save her marriage. The marriage was the crime.”

Package Status

Script: Complete draft, fully polished, ready for buyer read.

Attachments: None yet confirmed — update this line once cast, director, or producers are formally attached.

Rights: Original screenplay, developed and owned by NCCA Entertainment.